

Sara Costa

Security Engineer | Cloud Security | Detection & Response

Sarasota, FL | Active Secret Clearance | sarasignedin@gmail.com

linkedin.com/in/sara-risotti | github.com/sarasignedin | papaya.kiwi

Professional Summary

Security Engineer with 7+ years of experience across cloud security operations, threat detection, vulnerability management, and remediation engineering in AWS, Azure, and GCP environments. Proven record improving security posture through detection tuning, control validation, and infrastructure-as-code remediation. Strong cross-functional communicator with hands-on Python and Terraform automation experience.

Technical Skills

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Azure, GCP, Kubernetes, Docker

Security & CNAPP: Prisma/Cortex Cloud, Wiz, XSOAR, XSIAM, Splunk, Cribl, CSPM, DSPM, CWPP, CIEM, PKI, Computer Forensics

Detection & Response: SIEM triage, alert enrichment, incident-response workflows, control-gap analysis

IaC & Automation: Terraform, Python, Bash

Programming Languages: Python, C/C++, C#, JavaScript, HTML/PHP, SQL

Data & Analytics: MS SQL Server, Oracle, AppDynamics, DataRobot, Quantum Metric, KNIME

Protocols & Systems: TCP/IP, HTTP, DNS, SMTP, Windows/Linux APIs and system-call familiarity

Experience

Founder & Cloud Security Consultant

Papaya Kiwi Consulting LLC

Nov 2025 – Present

Remote, USA

- Led security engineering engagements across Kubernetes and Docker workloads in 10+ client environments, focused on vulnerability management, hardening, and remediation execution.
- Built prompt-to-pipeline remediation workflows that reduced manual security fix steps by up to 40% for approved infrastructure changes.
- Filed USPTO Provisional Patent #64/022,497 for a dual-agent advisory method that converts natural-language remediation intent into structured execution workflows.
- Presented at BSides South Florida 2026 (Technical Track): From Prompt to Pipeline: How Dual-Agent Method Automates Cloud Security Remediation.

Consultant (Private Subcontractor – Professional Services for PANW)

Palo Alto Networks Services Ecosystem

Aug 2024 – Oct 2025

Remote, USA

- Served as primary SME for CSPM and DSPM programs across AWS, Azure, and GCP in 12 enterprise environments, identifying control gaps and remediation priorities.
- Analyzed vulnerability findings, authored client-facing risk reports, and delivered corrective-action plans for security and platform teams.
- Integrated Prisma Cloud findings into Splunk SIEM to improve detection visibility, triage workflows, and incident response context.
- Automated remediation workflows with Python and Terraform, improving response consistency and reducing manual remediation effort by approximately 40%.

Security Consultant

BxC Security

Sept 2022 – Feb 2024

Germany

- Conducted security posture assessments and vulnerability gap analysis across AWS and Azure for 8 client engagements, producing prioritized remediation roadmaps.
- Assessed privileged access management and identity controls, documenting risk-treatment plans for enterprise stakeholders.

- Designed corporate PKI architecture and authored technical documentation to support secure operational processes.

US Army Reserves – Information Technology Specialist (25B), Signal Support Systems Specialist (25U),
Human Intelligence Collector (35M) July 2021 – Present
United States Part Time

- Provided technical support to 50+ personnel in classified and unclassified environments with emphasis on secure communications, availability, and operational resilience.
- Managed NIPR/SIPR Cisco switch configuration and maintenance for mission-critical network operations.

Software Developer / Data Scientist Mar 2019 – June 2020
BENTELER Group Paderborn, Germany

- Built IoT software and KPI dashboards using Python, SQL, and Oracle across 2 enterprise database platforms (MS SQL Server and Oracle), tracking 15+ operational KPIs.
- Contributed across planning, development, and testing with C/C++, C#, and JavaScript in production systems.

Speaking & Projects

- BSides South Florida 2026 Speaker: From Prompt to Pipeline: How Dual-Agent Method Automates Cloud Security Remediation.
- Patent-Pending AI System: USPTO Provisional #64/022,497 (Dual-Agent advisory and remediation method).
- Google SecOps (Chronicle) workshop challenge: investigated a pre-ingested dataset representing a full attack chain against a fictitious organization across 18 challenges, including raw log search, UDM field navigation, script block forensics, lateral movement tracking, and obfuscation analysis.
- Challenge performance: 1,800 points, 121st place, and 16/18 challenges solved within the CTF window.
- Additional cloud security project work and tooling references available at github.com/sarasignedin.

Certifications

CompTIA Security+ ce

Education

M.S., Cyber Technology	University of Maryland Global Campus, 2024
B.S., Network Security	LSU Shreveport, 2019
A.S., Cyber Security	SUNY Westchester Community College, 2017